



The physical item is mycoprotein nuggets. My intention was to create a “false familiarity” with mcdonald’s chicken mcnuggets, to allow the general public to get to know that fungi can be used as a protein source as well. The shape of the nuggets was formed by clay before using wool felt to wrap around the clay. The wool felt texture is meant to resemble the mycelium biomass of filamentous fungi, *Fusarium venenatum*, one of the most commercialised fungi used for mycoprotein production(Fig 1). Two cut pieces of the nuggets also feature foam balls on its surface, meant to resemble conidiospores of *Aspergillus oryzae* (Fig 2), which is another species used for mycoprotein production(Wall, 2020; Gamarra-Castillo, 2022), though there are several other fungi species in use as well which I was not able to fully capture.

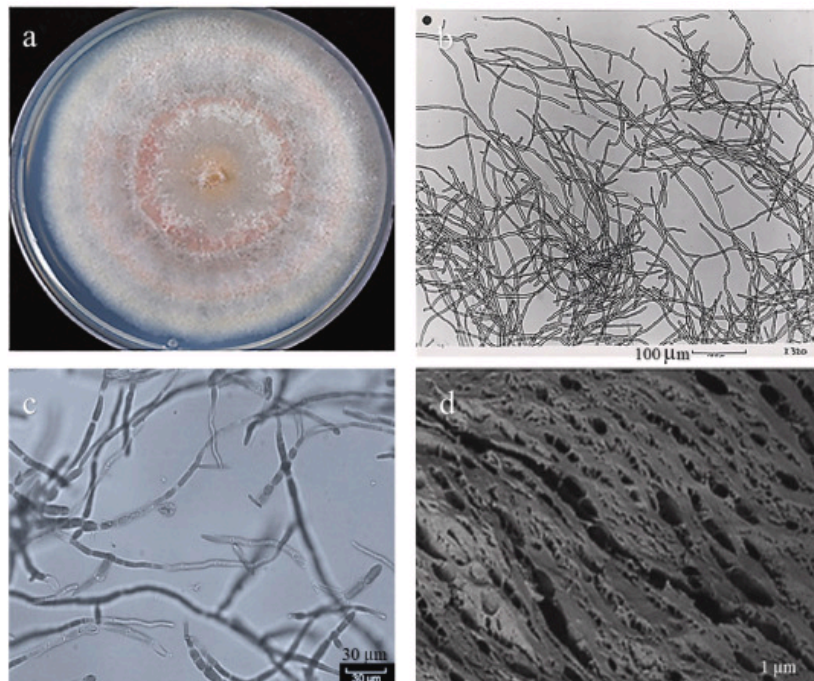


Fig 1. *Fusarium* culture morphology. (Source: Gnaim et al., 2025a)

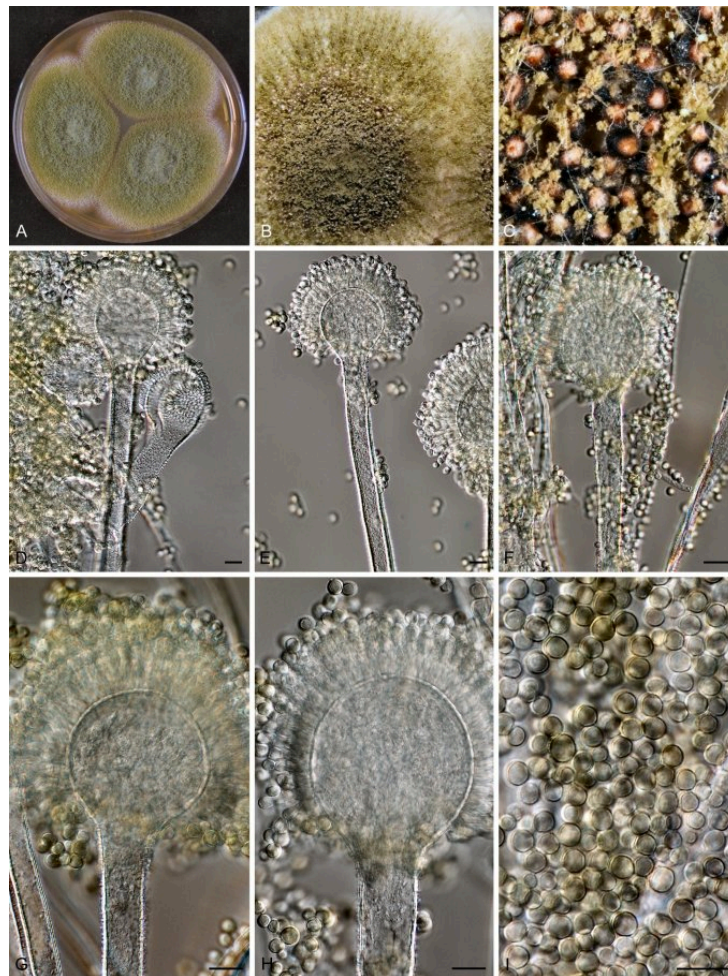


Fig 2. Different views of *Aspergillus oryzae* (Source : Varga et al., 2011)

The primary goal of this work was to present an application of fungi in the food industry. Many people are familiar with plant and insect protein as an alternative to animal protein, but mycoprotein does not get the same spotlight despite offering higher nutritional content and fast growth using less space (Lee et al., 2024; Gnaim et al., 2025b). Furthermore, this work also helps to show the fungi comes in a range of physical forms, not only the mushroom shape they are familiar with. The mushrooms painted on the outer box is only to provide a simple visualisation of what people think of when they hear fungi, and is not meant to represent any part of the nuggets.

Reference list

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